

SSC CGL Complete Study Notes Compilation

Simple & Compound Interest | Number, Alphabet & Figure Series
Direct & Indirect Speech | Static GK: Indian Polity

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Chapter 1: Simple & Compound Interest

1. Core Definitions

Term	Meaning
Principal (P)	The original amount invested or borrowed
Rate (R)	Interest rate per annum (%)
Time (T)	Duration in years
Amount (A)	Total money received/paid = Principal + Interest

2. Simple Interest (SI)

Formula

$$SI = (P \times R \times T) / 100$$

$$A = P + SI$$

Interest is calculated only on the principal — it remains constant each year.

Percentage Method (Fast Calculations)

Convert rate% x time into a percentage of principal:

- Rate = 10%, Time = 4 years → SI = 40% of Principal
- Principal = 100%, Amount = 140%

3. Compound Interest (CI)

Formula

$$A = P \times (1 + R/100)^T$$

$$CI = A - P$$

Interest is calculated on principal + accumulated interest — it grows exponentially.

Compounding Frequencies

Frequency	Formula
Annually	$A = P(1 + R/100)^T$
Half-yearly	$A = P(1 + R/200)^{2T}$
Quarterly	$A = P(1 + R/400)^{4T}$

4. Comparison: SI vs CI

Feature	Simple Interest	Compound Interest
Basis	Only principal	Principal + accumulated interest
Growth	Linear	Exponential
Interest	Constant each period	Increases each period

5. Key Shortcut Formulas (SSC CGL)

Difference between CI and SI for 2 years

$$CI - SI = P \times (R/100)^2$$

This is critical for SSC CGL — frequently tested!

For 3 years

$$CI - SI = P \times (R/100)^2 \times (3 + R/100)$$

SI and CI Ratio for 2 years at R%

$$SI : CI = 100R : [100(1 + R/100)^2 - 100]$$

or simply,

$$SI : CI = 2 : (2 + R/100) \text{ [approx]}$$

6. SSC CGL Previous Year Questions (PYQs)

Q1: Difference between CI and SI (Classic)

Q: The difference between CI and SI on ₹x at 12% p.a. for 2 years is ₹18. Find x.

Solution:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{CI} - \text{SI} &= P \times (R/100)^2 \\ 18 &= x \times (12/100)^2 \\ 18 &= x \times 144/10000 \\ x &= 18 \times 10000/144 = ₹1250 \end{aligned}$$

Answer: ₹1250

Q2: Finding Rate from SI and CI

Q: SI and CI earned in 2 years at same rate are ₹1000 and ₹1040 respectively. Find rate.

Solution:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{CI} - \text{SI} &= 1040 - 1000 = ₹40 \\ 40 &= P \times (R/100)^2 \dots (1) \\ \text{SI} &= P \times R \times 2/100 = 1000 \dots (2) \\ \text{From (2): } P &= 50000/R \\ \text{Substitute in (1): } 40 &= (50000/R) \times (R^2/10000) \\ 40 &= 5R \\ R &= 8\% \end{aligned}$$

Answer: 8% p.a.

Q3: Amount doubles concept

Q: A sum at CI doubles in 5 years. What will it become in 20 years?

Solution:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Amount doubles every } 5 \text{ years} \\ 20 \text{ years} &= 4 \text{ cycles of } 5 \text{ years} \\ \text{Amount} &= P \times 2^4 = 16P \end{aligned}$$

Answer: 16 times the principal

Q4: Two different rates on parts

Q: ₹17,200 lent in two parts for 2 years at 8% and 10% p.a. Total interest = ₹3008. Find amount at 8%.

Solution:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Let part at } 8\% &= x, \text{ at } 10\% = (17200 - x) \\ (x \times 8 \times 2)/100 + (17200 - x) \times 10 \times 2/100 &= 3008 \\ 16x/100 + 20(17200 - x)/100 &= 3008 \\ 16x + 344000 - 20x &= 300800 \\ -4x &= -43200 \\ x &= ₹10,800 \end{aligned}$$

Answer: ₹10,800

Q5: Equal Annual Instalments

Q: ₹4,620 to be paid in 2 equal annual instalments at 10% CI. Find each instalment.

Solution:

Each instalment = x

Present value = $x/(1.1) + x/(1.1)^2 = 4620$

$x/1.1 + x/1.21 = 4620$

$(1.1x + x)/1.21 = 4620$

$2.1x = 4620 \times 1.21$

$x = ₹2,662$

Answer: ₹2,662

Q6: Half-yearly Compounding

Q: Difference between CI and SI for 2 years at 20% is ₹200. Find difference for 1st year if compounded half-yearly.

Solution:

SI for 2 years = 40% of P

CI for 2 years = $P[(1.2)^2 - 1] = 44\%$ of P

Difference = 4% of $P = 200 \rightarrow P = 5000$

For half-yearly:

CI (1 year) = $P[(1.1)^2 - 1] = 21\%$ of $P = 1050$

SI (1 year) = 20% of $P = 1000$

Difference = ₹50

Answer: ₹50

7. Quick Reference Card

FORMULA SUMMARY

SI = $(P \times R \times T)/100$ A = $P + SI$

A = $P(1 + R/100)^T$ CI = $A - P$

CI - SI (2 years) = $P(R/100)^2$

CI - SI (3 years) = $P(R/100)^2 \times (3 + R/100)$

Half-yearly: A = $P(1 + R/200)^{(2T)}$

Quarterly: A = $P(1 + R/400)^{(4T)}$

Rate = $(CI - SI)/SI \times 100$ (for 1st year)

Rate from Amounts: $R = [(A_2/A_1) - 1] \times 100$

Chapter 2: Number, Alphabet & Figure Series

1. Number Series

Definition

A number series is a sequence of numbers following a specific pattern or rule. The task is to identify the pattern and find the missing/next term.

Common Patterns in Number Series

Pattern Type	Example	Rule
Addition/Subtraction	2, 5, 8, 11, ?	+3 each time $\rightarrow$ 14
Multiplication/Division	3, 6, 12, 24, ?	$\times 2$ each time $\rightarrow$ 48
Mixed Operations	2, 5, 10, 17, ?	+3, +5, +7 $\rightarrow$ +9 = 26
Squares/Cubes	1, 4, 9, 16, ?	$1^2, 2^2, 3^2, 4^2 \rightarrow 5^2 = 25$
Prime Numbers	2, 3, 5, 7, 11, ?	Next prime $\rightarrow$ 13
Fibonacci	0, 1, 1, 2, 3, 5, ?	Sum of previous two $\rightarrow$ 8
Alternate Series	1, 4, 3, 6, 5, 8, ?	+3, -1, +3, -1 $\rightarrow$ 7
Square +/- Number	2, 10, 30, 68, ?	$1^3+1, 2^3+2, 3^3+3, 4^3+4 \rightarrow 5^3+5=130$

Important Shortcut Patterns (SSC CGL)

Pattern 1: Difference-based series

Example: 5, 11, 21, 35, 53, ?

Differences: 6, 10, 14, 18 $\rightarrow$ +4 each time

Next difference = 22 $\rightarrow$ 53 + 22 = 75

Pattern 2: Two-level difference (Square relation)

Example: 1, 5, 14, 30, 55, ?

Differences: 4, 9, 16, 25 $\rightarrow$ $2^2, 3^2, 4^2, 5^2$

Next difference = $6^2 = 36 \rightarrow$ 55 + 36 = 91

Pattern 3: Multiplication + Addition

Example: 2, 5, 14, 41, ?

$\times 2+1, \times 3-1, \times 4-3, \times 5+?$

OR

$\times 3-1, \times 3-1, \times 3-1 \rightarrow 41 \times 3-1 = 122$

Pattern 4: Square of positions

Example: 2, 7, 28, 77, ?

$1^3+1, 2^3-1, 3^3+1, 4^3-1 \rightarrow 5^3+1 = 126$

2. Alphabet Series

Alphabet Positions (A=1 to Z=26)

A=1 B=2 C=3 D=4 E=5 F=6 G=7 H=8 I=9 J=10
K=11 L=12 M=13 N=14 O=15 P=16 Q=17 R=18 S=19 T=20
U=21 V=22 W=23 X=24 Y=25 Z=26

Common Alphabet Patterns

Pattern Type	Example	Rule
Direct Sequence	B, D, F, H, ?	+2 → J
Reverse Sequence	Z, X, V, T, ?	-2 → R
Mixed (+/- alternating)	A, C, F, H, K, ?	+2, +3, +2, +3 → M
Vowel pattern	A, E, I, O, ?	Vowels → U
Letter + Position	A, B, D, G, K, ?	+0, +1, +2, +3 → +4 = O
Opposite letters	A, Z, B, Y, C, ?	A→Z, B→Y, C→X
Pairs pattern	AD, BE, CF, DG, ?	+1,+1 → EH
Reverse alphabet code	Z=1, Y=2, X=3...	1→Z, 2→Y

Special SSC CGL Tricks for Alphabets

Trick 1: Sum of Positions

A + D = 1 + 4 = 5 = E
B + E = 2 + 5 = 7 = G
C + F = 3 + 6 = 9 = I
Pattern: A, D → E ; B, E → G ; C, F → I ; D, G → ?

Trick 2: Opposite Letters (Sum = 27)

A ↔ Z (1+26=27)
B ↔ Y (2+25=27)
C ↔ X (3+24=27)

Trick 3: Middle Letter

ABD, BCE, CDF, ?
A+1=B, B+2=D → Pattern

3. Figure Series (Non-Verbal)

Common Figure Patterns

Pattern Type	Description
Rotation	Figures rotate clockwise/anticlockwise
Addition/Removal	New elements added or removed stepwise
Mirror/Water Image	Reflection of figures
Counting	Number of lines/shapes increases/decreases
Position Shift	Elements move within the figure

Pattern Type	Description
Embedded Figures	One figure contains another
Coding-Decoding	Figures with numbers/letters

Key Observations for Figure Series

- Check Rotation: 45°, 90°, 180° clockwise/anticlockwise
- Count Elements: Lines, circles, triangles, squares
- Positional Changes: Top→Bottom, Left→Right
- Alternating: Two sets of figures alternate
- Combination: Multiple patterns combined

4. SSC CGL PYQs — Number Series

Q1: Simple Difference

Q: Find missing: 2, 6, 12, 20, 30, ?

Solution:

Difference: 4, 6, 8, 10 $\rightarrow$ +2 each time

Next difference = 12

$$30 + 12 = 42$$

Answer: 42

Q2: Multiplication Pattern

Q: What comes next: 3, 10, 32, 100, ?

Solution:

$$3 \times 3 + 1 = 10$$

$$10 \times 3 + 2 = 32$$

$$32 \times 3 + 4 = 100$$

$$100 \times 3 + 8 = 308$$

Answer: 308

Q3: Two Interwoven Series

Q: Find missing: 4, 7, 12, 19, 28, ?

Solution:

Differences: 3, 5, 7, 9 $\rightarrow$ +2 each time

Next difference = 11

$$28 + 11 = 39$$

Answer: 39

Q4: Square Pattern

Q: 0, 7, 26, 63, 124, ?

Solution:

$$1^3 - 1 = 0$$

$$2^3 - 1 = 7$$

$$3^3 - 1 = 26$$

$$4^3 - 1 = 63$$

$$5^3 - 1 = 124$$

$$6^3 - 1 = 215$$

Answer: 215

Q5: Complex Pattern

Q: 2, 3, 8, 27, 112, ?

Solution:

$$2 \times 1 + 1 = 3$$

$$3 \times 2 + 2 = 8$$

$$8 \times 3 + 3 = 27$$

$$27 \times 4 + 4 = 112$$

$$112 \times 5 + 5 = 565$$

Answer: 565

Q6: Fraction/Decimal Series

Q: 1, 8, 27, ?, 125, 216

Solution:

$$1^3 = 1$$

$$2^3 = 8$$

$$3^3 = 27$$

$$4^3 = 64$$

$$5^3 = 125$$

$$6^3 = 216$$

Answer: 64

5. SSC CGL PYQs — Alphabet Series

Q1: Direct +2 Pattern

Q: B, E, H, K, N, ?

Solution:

$$B(+3)=E \rightarrow E(+3)=H \rightarrow H(+3)=K \rightarrow K(+3)=N \rightarrow N(+3)=Q$$

Answer: Q

Q2: Alternating Pattern

Q: A, Z, B, Y, C, X, D, ?

Solution:

A, B, C, D (increasing by +1)

Z, Y, X (decreasing by -1)

Next = W

Answer: W

Q3: Increasing Step Pattern

Q: A, C, F, J, O, ?

Solution:

$$A(+2)=C \rightarrow C(+3)=F \rightarrow F(+4)=J \rightarrow J(+5)=O \rightarrow O(+6)=U$$

Answer: U

Q4: Alphabet Pairs

Q: AZ, BY, CX, DW, ?

Solution:

First letters: A, B, C, D $\rightarrow +1 \rightarrow E$

Second letters: Z, Y, X, W $\rightarrow -1 \rightarrow V$

Answer: EV

Q5: Reverse Alphabet Coding

Q: If Z = 1, Y = 2, X = 3, find next: J, L, N, P, ?

Solution:

J=17, L=15, N=13, P=11 (decreasing by 2)

Next = 9 = R

Answer: R

6. SSC CGL PYQs — Figure Series

(Note: In text format, figure questions are described. In actual exam, visual identification is needed.)

Q1: Rotation Pattern

Q: A figure rotates 90° clockwise each step. Identify next figure.

Solution:

Step 1: Square with dot on top
Step 2: Dot on right
Step 3: Dot on bottom
Step 4: Dot on left
Next: Dot on top again

Answer: Dot returns to top

Q2: Addition Pattern

Q: Figures show increasing number of lines: 1 line, 2 lines, 3 lines, ?

Solution:

Next figure has 4 lines

Answer: 4 lines

Q3: Embedded Figures

Q: A square has circle, then triangle, then hexagon, ?

Solution:

Number of sides: 0 (circle), 3, 6, 9 $\rightarrow$ Next has 12 sides

Answer: 12 sides

7. Quick Reference Card

NUMBER SERIES PATTERNS

check differences first (+/-, $\times/\div$)
Look for squares/cubes ($1^2, 2^2, 3^2$ OR $1^3, 2^3, 3^3$)
Prime numbers, Fibonacci, Alternating
Two-level differences (2nd difference constant)
Multiplication + addition ($xn + m$)

ALPHABET SERIES

A=1 B=2 C=3 ... Z=26 (Memorize!)
Direct +/- pattern
Alternating +/-
Increasing step ($a+2, a+3, a+4$)
Opposite letters (sum = 27)
Pairs pattern

FIGURE SERIES

Rotation (Clockwise/Anticlockwise)

Addition/Removal of elements

Position shifting (Top→Bottom→Left→Right)

Mirror/Water images

Counting lines/shapes

8. SSC CGL Exam Tips

Number Series

- Check difference first - most common SSC pattern
- Look at second difference if first difference doesn't work
- Try $\times/\div$ pattern with $+/-$ combination
- Check squares/cubes - very frequent in Tier 1
- Identify alternate series (odd positions vs even positions)

Alphabet Series

- Always convert to numbers first (A=1, B=2...)
- Check addition/subtraction pattern like number series
- Watch for reversal patterns (A→Z, B→Y)
- Vowel/consonant patterns less common but tested
- Use 27 - position for reverse coding

Figure Series

- Mental rotation - visualize 90°, 180° turns
- Count carefully - lines, dots, shapes
- Compare adjacent figures for changes
- Look for hidden patterns - part of figure moving
- Eliminate options first when stuck

Golden Rules

1. No pattern is random - find the underlying logic
2. Try to apply 2-3 patterns mentally
3. Work backwards from options if stuck
4. In SSC, multiple patterns may exist - choose simplest
5. For alphabets, 27 - position = opposite letter

Chapter 3: Direct & Indirect Speech

1. Core Definitions

Term	Meaning
Direct Speech	Exact words of the speaker, enclosed in quotation marks (" ")
Indirect Speech	Reporting the speaker's words without quoting exactly (no quotation marks)
Reporting Verb	The verb that introduces the speech (say, tell, ask, etc.)

Example

Direct	Indirect
He said, "I am happy."	He said that he was happy.

2. Basic Conversion Rules

Rule 1: Remove Quotation Marks

- Direct: " ... " → Remove
- Use 'that' as a connector (for statements)

Rule 2: Change of Pronouns

- First Person (I, we, my, our) → Changes according to the subject of reporting verb
- Second Person (you, your) → Changes according to the object of reporting verb
- Third Person (he, she, it, they) → No change

Direct	Indirect
He said, "I am fine."	He said that he was fine.
She said to me, "You are right."	She told me that I was right.
I said, "They are coming."	I said that they were coming.

Rule 3: Change of Tense

Direct Speech Tense	Indirect Speech Tense
Present Indefinite	Past Indefinite
Present Continuous	Past Continuous
Present Perfect	Past Perfect
Present Perfect Continuous	Past Perfect Continuous
Past Indefinite	Past Perfect
Past Continuous	Past Perfect Continuous
Past Perfect	No Change
Future (shall/will)	Would
Can	Could
May	Might

Direct Speech Tense	Indirect Speech Tense
Must	Had to / Must

Tense Change Examples

Direct	Indirect
She said, "I eat."	She said that she ate.
She said, "I am eating."	She said that she was eating.
She said, "I have eaten."	She said that she had eaten.
She said, "I ate."	She said that she had eaten.
She said, "I will eat."	She said that she would eat.
She said, "I can eat."	She said that she could eat.

Rule 4: Exception - No Tense Change When

Tense does NOT change if:

Universal Truths / Habits / Facts

Direct: He said, "The earth revolves around the sun."

Indirect: He said that the earth revolves around the sun. (No change)

Reporting Verb is in Present or Future

Direct: He says, "I am tired."

Indirect: He says that he is tired. (No change)

3. Change of Time & Place Words

Direct	Indirect
Now	Then
Today	That day
Tonight	That night
Yesterday	The previous day / The day before
Tomorrow	The next day / The following day
Here	There
This	That
These	Those
Ago	Before
Last night	The previous night
Next week	The following week

Example

Direct	Indirect
He said, "I am here today."	He said that he was there that day.

4. Types of Sentences

A. Assertive Sentences (Statements)

Rule: said/said to → said/told

- said to changes to told (when object is given)
- said remains said (if no object)

Direct	Indirect
He said, "I am going."	He said that he was going.
He said to me, "I am going."	He told me that he was going.

Formula

Subject + Reporting Verb + Object(optional) + that + Reported Speech (changed)

B. Interrogative Sentences (Questions)

- Rule 1: Remove quotation marks and use if/whether for Yes/No questions
- Rule 2: For Wh-questions, use the same Wh-word
- Rule 3: Change said/said to → asked / enquired / demanded
- Rule 4: Make the sentence affirmative (remove question mark, change word order)

Direct	Indirect
He said to me, "Are you coming?"	He asked me if I was coming.
He said to me, "Where are you going?"	He asked me where I was going.
He said, "Do you know me?"	He asked if I knew him.

C. Imperative Sentences (Commands/Requests)

Rule 1: Change reporting verb to:

- Order / Command / Tell (for commands)
- Request / Beg (for requests)
- Advise / Suggest (for advice)
- Forbid (for negative commands)
- Rule 2: Use 'to' + verb (infinitive)
- Rule 3: Negative commands use 'not to'

Direct	Indirect
He said to me, "Go out."	He ordered me to go out.
He said to me, "Please help me."	He requested me to help him.
He said, "Don't go there."	He forbade me to go there. / He told me not to go there.

D. Exclamatory Sentences

Rule: Change said to exclaimed with joy/sorrow/surprise/wonder. Common changes:

- What / How → Very
- Alas! → exclaimed with sorrow
- Hurrah! → exclaimed with joy
- Wow! → exclaimed with surprise

Direct	Indirect
He said, "What a beautiful flower!"	He exclaimed with wonder that it was a very beautiful flower.
He said, "Alas! I am ruined."	He exclaimed with sorrow that he was ruined.
He said, "Hurrah! We won."	He exclaimed with joy that they had won.

E. Optative Sentences (Wishes/Blessings)

Rule: Change said to wished / prayed / blessed. Use 'that' as connector.

Direct	Indirect
He said, "May you succeed!"	He wished that I might succeed.
He said to me, "May God bless you!"	He prayed that God might bless me.

5. Summary Table — All Rules at a Glance

DIRECT → INDIRECT SUMMARY

STATEMENTS:

"..." → that | said to → told | Pronoun/Tense change

QUESTIONS:

Yes/No → if/whether | Wh- → same Wh-word

said to → asked | Question mark removed

COMMANDS:

Verb → to + Verb | Negative → not to + Verb

said to → ordered/requested/advised

EXCLAMATIONS:

said → exclaimed with joy/sorrow/wonder

What/How → very

WISHES:

said → wished/prayed/blessed | May → might

6. SSC CGL Previous Year Questions

Q1: Basic Tense Change

Q: He said, "I am going to Delhi."

Answer: He said that he was going to Delhi.

Q2: Interrogative (Yes/No)

Q: She said to me, "Do you like coffee?"

Answer: She asked me if I liked coffee.

Q3: Interrogative (Wh-word)

Q: The teacher said to me, "Why are you late?"

Answer: The teacher asked me why I was late.

Q4: Imperative (Command)

Q: The officer said to the clerk, "Finish this work immediately."

Answer: The officer ordered the clerk to finish that work immediately.

Q5: Imperative (Negative)

Q: Mother said to me, "Don't waste your time."

Answer: Mother advised me not to waste my time.

Q6: Imperative (Request)

Q: He said to me, "Please lend me your book."

Answer: He requested me to lend him my book.

Q7: Exclamatory

Q: He said, "What a beautiful sunset!"

Answer: He exclaimed with wonder that it was a very beautiful sunset.

Q8: Exclamatory (Sorrow)

Q: She said, "Alas! My pet is dead."

Answer: She exclaimed with sorrow that her pet was dead.

Q9: Optative (Wish)

Q: The priest said, "May God bless you!"

Answer: The priest prayed that God might bless him/her.

Q10: Universal Truth (No Tense Change)

Q: The teacher said, "The sun rises in the east."

Answer: The teacher said that the sun rises in the east. (No tense change)

Q11: Reporting Verb in Present (No Tense Change)

Q: He says, "I am tired."

Answer: He says that he is tired. (No tense change)

Q12: Time/Place Change

Q: She said, "I will meet you here tomorrow."

Answer: She said that she would meet me there the next day.

Q13: Mixed — Two Clauses

Q: He said, "I have completed my work and I am leaving now."

Answer: He said that he had completed his work and was leaving then.

Q14: 'Said to' vs 'Said'

Q: He said to her, "You are beautiful."

Solution:

Note: said to → told (object present)

Answer: He told her that she was beautiful.

Q15: Complex Question

Q: The stranger asked me, "Can you tell me the way to the station?"

Answer: The stranger asked me if I could tell him the way to the station.

7. Quick Revision Card

QUICK CONVERSION CHART

PRONOUN CHANGES:

I/We → He/She/They (according to subject)

You → I/He/She/We/They (according to object)

My/Our → His/Her/Their

VERB CHANGES:

am/is/are → was/were | has/have → had | do/does → did

will → would | can → could | may → might

TIME CHANGES:

now→then today→that day yesterday→the previous day

tomorrow→the next day here→there this→that

REPORTING VERBS:

Said → Said/Told Said to → Told

Questions → Asked/Enquired Commands → Ordered/Requested

Exclamations → Exclaimed with joy/sorrow/wonder

Wishes → Wished/Prayed/Blessed

8. SSC CGL Exam Tips

Golden Rules for SSC CGL

- 1 1. Identify the type of sentence first (statement/question/command/exclamation)
- 2 2. Check for 'said to' vs 'said': If said to → change to told (if object exists); If said (no object) → remains said
- 3 3. Check pronoun carefully: First person → matches subject of reporting verb; Second person → matches object of reporting verb
- 4 4. For questions, always: Change to affirmative word order; Remove question mark; Use if/whether for Yes/No questions
- 5 5. For commands, always use: to + V1 for positive; not to + V1 for negative
- 6 6. Look for exceptions: Universal truth → No tense change; Reporting verb in present/future → No tense change
- 7 7. Common SSC traps: Forgetting to change pronouns; Forgetting to change time/place words; Using said instead of told when object exists; Not changing interrogative word order

Common Errors to Avoid

Wrong	Correct
He said that I am going.	He said that he was going.
He asked me that where I was going.	He asked me where I was going.
He ordered me that I go out.	He ordered me to go out.
She said that she can do it.	She said that she could do it.
He said that he will come tomorrow.	He said that he would come the next day.

Chapter 4: Static GK — Indian Polity

Parliament, President, Judiciary

1. The President of India

Constitutional Position

- Head of State of the Republic of India
- Nominal/Constitutional/Titular Head – exercises powers on the aid and advice of the Council of Ministers (Art. 74)
- First Citizen of India
- Supreme Commander of the Armed Forces

Qualification (Art. 58)

- Must be a citizen of India
- Must have completed 35 years of age
- Must be qualified for election as a member of the Lok Sabha
- Must not hold any office of profit under Government of India or any State Government

Election Process (Art. 54)

Elected by an Electoral College consisting of:

- Elected members of Parliament (both Houses)
- Elected members of State Legislative Assemblies (including Delhi & Puducherry)

NOT elected by:

- Nominated members of Parliament
- Nominated members of State Legislatures
- Members of Legislative Councils (where exist)

Voting System: Single Transferable Vote (Proportional Representation) – Secret Ballot

Term & Removal

Aspect	Detail
Term	5 years from date of assuming office
Re-election	Eligible for re-election (no limit)
Resignation	Submit to Vice-President of India
Impeachment	For violation of Constitution (Art. 61)

Impeachment Process (Art. 61)

Step	Description
Initiation	Charges can be initiated by either House of Parliament
Notice	Requires 14 days' notice signed by 1/4th members of the House
Resolution	Passed by 2/3rd majority of the total membership of that House
Investigation	Other House investigates the charges

Step	Description
Final Removal	Other House passes resolution with 2/3rd majority

- President has right to defend himself/herself
- No prior impeachment of any Indian President (as of 2025)

Powers of the President

A. Executive Powers

Appoints:

- Prime Minister
- Council of Ministers
- Governors of States
- Attorney General
- Chief Justice & Judges of Supreme Court and High Courts
- Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG)
- Chief Election Commissioner
- Ambassadors to other countries

B. Legislative Powers

- Summons, prorogues, and addresses Parliament
- Dissolves Lok Sabha
- Gives assent to bills (Art. 111): Can give assent; Can withhold assent (pocket veto – first used in 1986 on Postal Bill); Can return for reconsideration (except Money Bills)
- Ordinance making power (Art. 123) – when Parliament not in session
- Lays reports before Parliament (CAG, UPSC, etc.)

C. Financial Powers

- Money Bill can only be introduced with President's recommendation
- Appoints Finance Commission
- Contingency Fund of India is under President's control

D. Judicial Powers

- Grants pardon, reprieve, respite, or remission of punishment (Art. 72)
- Can pardon death sentences (unlike Governor)

E. Emergency Powers (Art. 352-360)

Emergency Type	Article	Grounds
National Emergency	Art. 352	War, external aggression, armed rebellion
President's Rule	Art. 356	Failure of Constitutional machinery in State
Financial Emergency	Art. 360	Threat to financial stability

Important Articles Related to President

Article	Provision
52	President of India
53	Executive power of the Union
54	Election of President
55	Manner of election
56	Term of office

Article	Provision
57	Eligibility for re-election
58	Qualifications
60	Oath of office
61	Impeachment
72	Pardoning power
123	Ordinance-making power

SSC Special Facts

Fact	Detail
First President	Dr. Rajendra Prasad
Only President elected unopposed	Neelam Sanjiva Reddy
Youngest President	Neelam Sanjiva Reddy (64 years)
Oldest President	Dr. Rajendra Prasad (re-elected at 78)
First President to be impeached	None so far
President who used Pocket Veto	Giani Zail Singh (1986 – Indian Post Office Bill)

2. Parliament of India

Composition

Parliament consists of the President together with the Lok Sabha (Lower House / House of the People) and the Rajya Sabha (Upper House / Council of States). The President is an integral part of Parliament.

Lok Sabha (House of the People)

Aspect	Detail
Total Strength	552 (530 States + 20 UTs + 2 Anglo-Indian nominated)
Current Strength	543 (after deletion of Anglo-Indian nomination via 104th Amendment)
Term	5 years (can be dissolved early)
Membership	Directly elected by people (Universal Adult Franchise)
Age for Membership	25 years
Qualification	Citizen of India, registered voter, no office of profit
Speaker	Presides over Lok Sabha (elected by members)
First Speaker	G.V. Mavalankar

Key Functions

- Money Bills can only originate in Lok Sabha
- Vote of Confidence – Council of Ministers responsible to Lok Sabha
- Controls the executive through: Question Hour, Zero Hour, Adjournment Motion, No-Confidence Motion

Rajya Sabha (Council of States)

Aspect	Detail
Total Strength	250 (238 States/UTs + 12 nominated by President)
Current Strength	245
Term	6 years (permanent body – 1/3rd members retire every 2 years)
Membership	Indirectly elected by State Legislative Assemblies (Proportional Representation - STV)
Age for Membership	30 years
Qualification	Citizen of India, registered voter, no office of profit
Chairman	Vice-President of India (ex-officio)
Deputy Chairman	Elected by Rajya Sabha members

Key Functions

- Review and suggest amendments to bills passed by Lok Sabha
- Cannot initiate or reject Money Bills (only suggest amendments within 14 days)
- Represents states in the federal structure

Comparison: Lok Sabha vs Rajya Sabha

Parameter	Lok Sabha	Rajya Sabha
Direct Election	Yes	No (indirect)
Term	5 years (dissolution possible)	6 years (permanent, 1/3 retire every 2 years)
Age	25 years	30 years
Money Bill	Can originate	Cannot originate
No-Confidence	Can pass (PM removed)	Cannot pass
Strength	543	245
Presiding Officer	Speaker	Vice-President
Dissolution	Can be dissolved	Cannot be dissolved

Types of Bills

Bill Type	Description	Lok Sabha	Rajya Sabha
Ordinary Bill	Any subject except money	Can originate	Can originate
Money Bill	Art. 110 – taxation, borrowing, expenditure	Only originates	Can suggest amendments (14 days)
Constitutional Amendment Bill	Art. 368 – changes Constitution	Can originate	Can originate
Financial Bill	Similar to Money Bill but not exactly	Only originates	Can suggest amendments

Important Parliamentary Terms

Term	Meaning
Question Hour	First hour of sitting – members ask questions to ministers
Zero Hour	Immediately after Question Hour – 12:00 noon – raise matters of urgency
Adjournment Motion	Draws attention to urgent public matters (needs Speaker's consent)
No-Confidence Motion	Move against the Council of Ministers (only in Lok Sabha)
Censure Motion	Move against a specific minister or entire ministry
Cut Motion	Object to expenditure in a demand for grant
Calling Attention Motion	Minister explains an urgent matter
Prorogation	Ending a session by President
Adjournment	Suspension of sitting for a short period
Dissolution	Ending the life of Lok Sabha

Important Articles Related to Parliament

Article	Provision
79	Constitution of Parliament
80	Composition of Rajya Sabha
81	Composition of Lok Sabha
83	Duration of Houses
84	Qualification for membership
85	Sessions of Parliament
86	President's address
87	Special address by President
88	Rights of Ministers and Attorney General in Houses
100	Voting in Houses
105	Powers, privileges, and immunities of Parliament
109	Money Bills (special procedure)
110	Definition of Money Bill
111	Assent to Bills
123	Ordinance-making power of President

Sessions of Parliament

Session	Period	Important
Budget Session	February – May	Longest session; Railway & General Budget
Monsoon Session	July – August	Important bills
Winter Session	November – December	Shortest session

3. Judiciary of India

Supreme Court of India

The Supreme Court of India is the Guardian of the Constitution and the Apex (Highest) Court, consisting of the Chief Justice of India (CJI) and 33 other Judges (total 34 as per the 2019 Amendment).

Composition

Aspect	Detail
First CJI	Justice Harilal J. Kekisundas
Current Strength	CJI + 33 Judges (total 34)
Appointment	By President (consultation with CJI and other judges)
Retirement Age	65 years
Removal	By impeachment (2/3rd majority)
Seat	New Delhi

Jurisdiction of Supreme Court

Jurisdiction Type	Article	Description
Original Jurisdiction	Art. 131	Disputes between Centre and States or between States
Appellate Jurisdiction	Art. 132-136	Appeals against High Court decisions (Civil, Criminal, Constitutional)
Advisory Jurisdiction	Art. 143	President can seek Supreme Court's opinion (not binding)
Review Jurisdiction	Art. 137	Review its own judgments
Writ Jurisdiction	Art. 32	Fundamental Rights enforcement (Constitutional Remedy)

High Courts

Aspect	Detail
Highest Court in a State	
Article 214	Provides for High Courts
Appointment	President (consultation with CJI and Governor)
Retirement Age	62 years
Sanction of Judges	CJI + other judges (varies by High Court)
First High Court	Calcutta High Court (1862)
Largest High Court (area)	Allahabad High Court

Types of Writs (Art. 32 & 226)

Writ	Meaning	Issued Against
Habeas Corpus	"To have the body"	Illegal detention – produce the person before court
Mandamus	"We command"	To perform a legal duty (public official/corporation)
Certiorari	"To be certified"	Quashing order of lower court/tribunal
Prohibition	"To forbid"	To prevent lower court from exceeding jurisdiction
Quo Warranto	"By what authority"	To question appointment to public office

Key Concepts

Concept	Explanation
Judicial Review	Supreme Court can review laws passed by Parliament (Art. 13)
Public Interest Litigation (PIL)	Any citizen can approach court for public interest (introduced in 1980s)
Collegium System	Appointment of judges by a panel of judges (since 1993)
National Judicial Appointments Commission (NJAC)	Proposed to replace Collegium – struck down in 2015

Important Articles Related to Judiciary

Article	Provision
124	Establishment & Constitution of Supreme Court
125	Salaries of Supreme Court Judges
126	Appointment of Acting Chief Justice
127	Appointment of Ad-hoc Judges
129	Supreme Court as Court of Record
130	Seat of Supreme Court
131	Original Jurisdiction
132	Appellate Jurisdiction (Constitutional)
133	Appellate Jurisdiction (Civil)
134	Appellate Jurisdiction (Criminal)
137	Review Power
143	Advisory Jurisdiction
214	High Courts
217	Appointment of High Court Judges
226	High Court's Power of Writs

4. SSC CGL Previous Year Questions

Q1: President — Election

Q: The President of India is elected by:

- A. Only Lok Sabha members
- B. Only Rajya Sabha members
- C. Elected members of both Houses of Parliament and State Legislative Assemblies
- D. All members of Parliament

Answer: C. Elected members of both Houses of Parliament and State Legislative Assemblies

Q2: President — Qualification

Q: The minimum age for the President of India is:

- A. 25 years
- B. 30 years
- C. 35 years
- D. 40 years

Answer: C. 35 years

Q3: President — Removal

Q: The President of India can be removed from office by:

- A. Prime Minister
- B. Chief Justice of India
- C. Impeachment by Parliament (2/3rd majority)
- D. Supreme Court

Answer: C. Impeachment by Parliament (2/3rd majority)

Q4: President — Veto Power

Q: Which President used Pocket Veto for the first time?

- A. Dr. Rajendra Prasad
- B. Dr. Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan
- C. Giani Zail Singh
- D. V.V. Giri

Answer: C. Giani Zail Singh (Indian Post Office Bill, 1986)

Q5: Parliament — Lok Sabha

Q: What is the maximum strength of the Lok Sabha?

- A. 542
- B. 543
- C. 545
- D. 552

Answer: D. 552 (Originally 552 – currently 543)

Q6: Parliament — Rajya Sabha

Q: The Rajya Sabha is a permanent body. What fraction of its members retire every 2 years?

- A. 1/2
- B. 1/3
- C. 1/4
- D. 1/5

Answer: B. 1/3

Q7: Parliament — Money Bill

Q: Money Bill can only be introduced in:

- A. Rajya Sabha
- B. Lok Sabha
- C. Both Houses
- D. Joint Session

Answer: B. Lok Sabha

Q8: Parliament — Article 123

Q: The President's ordinance-making power is given under:

- A. Article 72
- B. Article 110
- C. Article 123
- D. Article 143

Answer: C. Article 123

Q9: Supreme Court — Article 32

Q: The Supreme Court is the guardian of Fundamental Rights under:

- A. Article 32
- B. Article 226
- C. Article 131
- D. Article 143

Answer: A. Article 32

Q10: Supreme Court — Age

Q: The retirement age of a Supreme Court Judge is:

- A. 60 years
- B. 62 years
- C. 65 years
- D. 70 years

Answer: C. 65 years

Q11: High Court — Age

Q: The retirement age of a High Court Judge is:

- A. 60 years
- B. 62 years
- C. 65 years
- D. 70 years

Answer: B. 62 years

Q12: Writ — Definition

Q: Which writ is issued to produce a person before the court?

- A. Mandamus
- B. Certiorari
- C. Habeas Corpus
- D. Prohibition

Answer: C. Habeas Corpus

Q13: Emergency — National

Q: National Emergency is declared under:

- A. Article 352
- B. Article 356
- C. Article 360
- D. Article 368

Answer: A. Article 352

Q14: President's Rule

Q: President's Rule in a State is imposed under:

- A. Article 352
- B. Article 356
- C. Article 360
- D. Article 124

Answer: B. Article 356

Q15: Parliamentary Session

Q: The Budget session of Parliament is held between:

- A. July – August
- B. November – December
- C. February – May
- D. June – July

Answer: C. February – May

Q16: Supreme Court — Advisory Jurisdiction

Q: The President can seek the opinion of the Supreme Court under:

- A. Article 131
- B. Article 132
- C. Article 143
- D. Article 137

Answer: C. Article 143

Q17: President — Ordinance

Q: An ordinance can be issued by the President when:

- A. Parliament is in session
- B. Parliament is not in session
- C. Lok Sabha is dissolved
- D. Rajya Sabha is dissolved

Answer: B. Parliament is not in session

Q18: Parliament — First Speaker

Q: Who was the first Speaker of Lok Sabha?

- A. M.A. Ayyangar
- B. Hukam Singh
- C. G.V. Mavalankar
- D. Neelam Sanjiva Reddy

Answer: C. G.V. Mavalankar

5. Quick Revision Card

PRESIDENT OF INDIA (QUICK)

Art. 52 – President of India

Age: 35 years | Term: 5 years | Re-election: Yes

Electoral College: Elected MPs + Elected MLAs

Voting: Single Transferable Vote (STV)

Impeachment: 2/3rd majority in both Houses

Emergency Powers: Art. 352 (National), 356 (State), 360 (Financial)

Pardoning Power: Art. 72 (can pardon death sentence)

Ordinance: Art. 123 (when Parliament not in session)

PARLIAMENT (QUICK)

LOK SABHA: 543 members | 25 years age | 5 years term

RAJYA SABHA: 245 members | 30 years age | 6 years term

Money Bill: Only Lok Sabha (Art. 110)

No-Confidence: Only Lok Sabha

Speaker: Lok Sabha | Vice-President: Rajya Sabha

Sessions: Budget (Feb-May), Monsoon (Jul-Aug), Winter (Nov-Dec)

JUDICIARY (QUICK)

SUPREME COURT: CJI + 33 Judges | Age: 65 years

HIGH COURT: Age: 62 years

5 WRITS: Habeas Corpus, Mandamus, Certiorari, Prohibition, Quo Warranto

Art. 32 – Supreme Court (Fundamental Rights)

Art. 226 – High Court (Writ jurisdiction)

Art. 143 – Advisory Jurisdiction (President can seek opinion)

6. SSC CGL Exam Tips

Tips for Polity Section

- 1 1. Memorize Articles by numbers – especially 52-61 (President), 79-123 (Parliament), 124-143 (Judiciary)
- 2 2. Don't confuse: Art. 32 (Supreme Court writs) vs Art. 226 (High Court writs); Art. 352 (National Emergency) vs Art. 356 (President's Rule); 35 years (President) vs 25 years (Lok Sabha) vs 30 years (Rajya Sabha)
- 3 3. Know the exceptions: President can be re-elected (no limit); Rajya Sabha CANNOT be dissolved; Money Bill CANNOT be introduced in Rajya Sabha
- 4 4. Remember firsts: First President: Dr. Rajendra Prasad; First Speaker: G.V. Mavalankar; First CJI: Justice H.J. Kekisundas
- 5 5. Identify correct word: 'Pardon' is for death sentence (President only); 'Impeachment' is for President (not removal); 'Dissolution' is only for Lok Sabha (not Rajya Sabha)

Common Traps in SSC CGL

Trap	Correct Answer
President is elected by all MPs	Only elected MPs + elected MLAs
President's term is 6 years	5 years
Rajya Sabha members are directly elected	Indirectly elected
Money Bill can be introduced in Rajya Sabha	Only Lok Sabha
Supreme Court judges retire at 62	65 years
High Court judges retire at 65	62 years
President's Rule is under Art. 352	Art. 356
National Emergency is under Art. 356	Art. 352